

Firearms Trace Data: Colorado - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

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ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in Colorado in Calendar Year 2023

8,786

Firearm Types with a Colorado Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Pistols	6,349
Rifles	993
Revolvers	765
Shotguns	516
Machinegun Conversion Devices	60
Machineguns	31
Other*	72

* Other includes Derringers, Receivers/Frames, Unknown Types, Any Other Weapons, Combinations, Silencers and a Destructive Device.

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with a Colorado Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	3,909
.22 Cal	740
.40 Cal	700
.45 Cal	654
.380 Cal	563

12GA	419
.38 Cal	295
.357 Cal	170
5.56mm	166
7.62mm	132

NOTE: There were 834 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were 204 traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Colorado Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Weapon Offense	1,908
Firearm Under Investigation	1,233
Found Firearm	1,017
Possession of Weapon	936
Traffic Offense	507
Property Crimes	385
Homicide	364
Aggravated Assault	357
Suicide	351
Dangerous Drugs	299

NOTE: There were 1,429 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearms with a Colorado Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Colorado	4,995
Texas	288
Wyoming	119
Florida	117
New Mexico	115
California	97
Arizona	82
Georgia	82
Kansas	80
Missouri	67
Tennessee	50
Nebraska	46
Mississippi	45
Nevada	43
Oklahoma	43
South Dakota	43

NOTE: An additional 30 states, the District of Columbia and Guam accounted for 630 other traces. The source state was identified in 6,942 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Colorado Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	494
3 Months to Under 7 Months	501
7 Months to Under 1 Year	514
1 Year to Under 2 Years	974
2 Years to Under 3 Years	837
3 Years and Over	3,607

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Colorado Average Time-to-Crime: **6.58 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Colorado Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	306
18 to 21	643
22 to 24	570
25 to 30	971
31 to 40	1,484
41 to 50	735
Over 50	803

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Colorado Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Colorado Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Denver	2,823
Colorado Springs	1,309
Aurora	608
Pueblo	593
Lakewood	380
Grand Junction	262
Arvada	142
Greeley	128
Loveland	125
Brighton	109

NOTE: There were 203 additional municipalities that accounted for 2,304 other traces. The recovery city could not be determined for three traces.

Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of Colorado. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to Colorado.
- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023.

- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.
- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with a Colorado Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Colorado Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with a Colorado Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Colorado Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Colorado Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.
- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Colorado Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024